Literary Studies - Structural Correspondence with the Five-Stage Model

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Literary Studies

Structural correspondence survey with the five-stage model (Ba, Nami, En, Uzu, Taba)

Survey Overview

- **Scope**: 10 major theories in literary studies
- **Research question**: Do theories in literary studies structurally correspond to the five-stage model?
- **Results**: Partial correspondence 1, Conditional correspondence 1

Overview of the Five-Stage Model

Stage	Definition
Ba (Field)	An undifferentiated state. Initial conditions where neither direction nor structure has yet been determined
Nami (Wave)	A stage of exploration where multiple directions diverge and compete
En (Edge)	A state of tension where opposing elements coexist without converging to either side. A place where elements meet at boundaries, influence each other, and relationships emerge
Uzu (Vortex)	A stage where new coherence (order) spontaneously arises from within tension
Taba (Bundle)	A stage where form is established and stabilizes as a reusable structure

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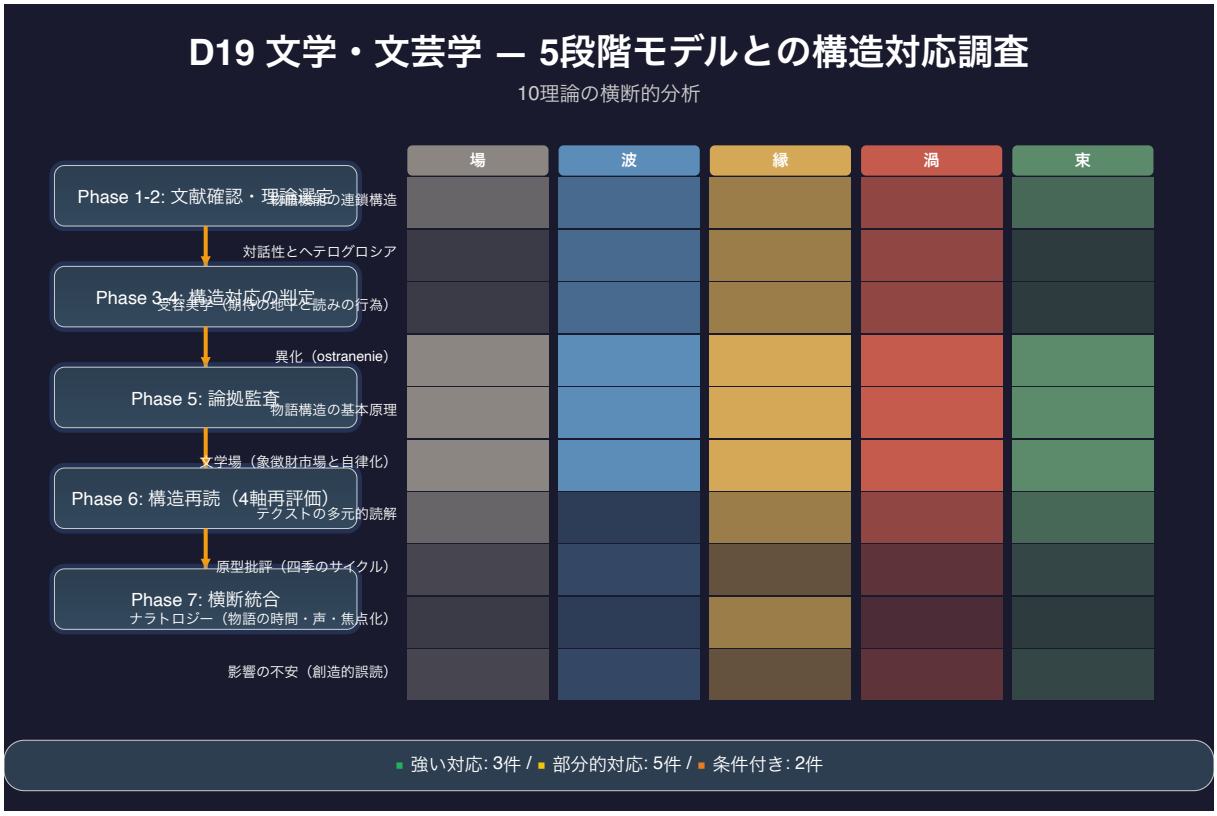

Figure 1: Domain — Research Overview Infographic

Figure 2: Domain — Theory x 5-Stage Correspondence Matrix

Overall Structural Correspondence

Temperature	Theory group	Assessment
Near-definitive	Shklovsky (defamiliarization), Jauss/Iser (reception aesthetics), Bakhtin (dialogism)	Descriptions of transitions are concrete, and correspondence across all five stages is clear
Probable	Propp (narrative functions), Barthes (plural reading of texts), Bourdieu (literary field), Bloom (anxiety of influence), Genette (narratology)	Correspondence exists but depth is concentrated at specific stages or involves compression
Conditional	Todorov (narrative structure), Frye (archetypal criticism)	Partial correspondence is visible, but primary source verification is incomplete (Todorov) or there are critiques of the system's arbitrariness (Frye), requiring cautious treatment

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Key Entry 1: Shklovsky's Defamiliarization (ostranenie)

- Shklovsky, one of the founders of Russian Formalism, proposed the concept of "defamiliarization" (ostranenie) in his 1917 essay "Art as Technique." He argued that the purpose of art is to restore things not as "known" but as "perception," and defamiliarization is the technique that makes the object "unfamiliar" and prolongs the time of perception against perception "automatized" by repetition. Poetic language realizes the recovery of perception not through the efficiency of understanding but through the "roughening" (zatrudnenie) and delay of form.
- **As fact**: Shklovsky pointed out that when perception is automatized through everyday repetition, the world becomes "unlived." Art is resistance to this automatization, and it is an endeavor that renews perception itself through techniques (defamiliarization) that re-present objects as unfamiliar (Shklovsky, 1917 "Art as Technique").
- **As reading**: Here we read the dynamic structure of perception — the cycle of habituation and de-habituation. The level of similarity is process, and in particular we focus on the sequential order of the cycle: "automatized perception is recovered through defamiliarization and eventually re-automatizes."
- **As interpretation**: Habituated perception — the state in which the world is dissolved into the "known" — corresponds to Ba in the five stages. Awareness of automatization and sensing of dullness corresponds to Nami. The introduction of defamiliarization devices — setting the boundary between prose and poetic language, the operation of creating tension between technique and perception — corresponds to En. The moment when the object arises "anew" within delayed perception corresponds to Uzu. The state in which techniques are shared and normalized, and eventually exposed again to automatization pressure, corresponds to Taba, and this Taba returns to a new Ba.
- What is interesting about this theory is that it conceives of creation not only as "making something new" but as "perceiving the known as new." Defamiliarization suggests that the structural change described by the five-stage model can be applied not only to production but also to the renewal of perception.

Key Entry 2: Reception Aesthetics of Jauss/Iser

- Reception aesthetics, represented by Jauss (1967) and Iser (1972) of the Constance School, is a theory that finds the meaning of literary works not in the author's intention but in the interaction between reader and text.
- **As fact**: Jauss proposed the concept of "horizon of expectation" (Erwartungshorizont). Readers form a framework of anticipation from genre, preceding works, and social context, and the value of a work is measured by its deviation from the horizon of expectation (aesthetic distance). Iser, on

the other hand, proposed the concept of "gaps" (Leerstellen). Texts contain intentionally omitted sections, and readers actively supplement these gaps to generate meaning (Iser, 1972 *Der implizite Leser*).

- **As reading**: Here we read the dynamics in which the discrepancy arising between the reader's anticipatory structure and the work drives meaning generation. The level of similarity is process, and we focus on the generation sequence: "existing anticipatory frame → introduction of deviation by the work → active supplementation by the reader → establishment of new meaning."
- **As interpretation**: The horizon of expectation formed by the reader from experience of preceding works and genres corresponds to Ba in the five stages. The aesthetic distance generated when the work betrays expectations corresponds to Nami. The phase in which the reader actively supplements the gaps in the text and the text and reader are joined as a relationship corresponds to En. The moment when new meaning is established as a coherence through supplementation corresponds to Uzu; and the phase in which interpretation is shared and accumulated in the critical community and established as literary-historical evaluation corresponds to Taba.
- For example, when a mystery reader has the expectation "the culprit is probably this person," and that expectation is overturned, the reader re-reads the clues and reconstructs the entire story from a new perspective. This reconstruction is established not by the author handing over the "answer" but by the reader filling in the gaps of the text themselves.
- The important contribution of reception aesthetics is shifting "the subject of meaning generation" from the author to the reader. For the five-stage model, it is a concrete case demonstrating that creation does not conclude within the individual but occurs at the interface of work and recipient.

Key Entry 3: Bakhtin's Dialogism and Heteroglossia

- Bakhtin argued that language is inherently dialogic, and that all utterances contain responses to other utterances. "Heteroglossia" (heteroglossia / raznorechie) refers to the socially stratified diversity of language, and the novel functions as a site where this polyphonic language negotiates and collides.
- **As fact**: Bakhtin analyzed the novel not as a monologic form governed by a single voice, but as a polyphonic structure in which different social languages negotiate and collide (Bakhtin, 1934-35/1981 "Discourse in the Novel"). In the concept of "dialogism," all language responds to and contains other language, and monologic language is regarded as an artificial product that suppresses dialogue (Bakhtin, 1929/1984). In the concept of "carnival," the temporary inversion of public order and the tension between authoritative discourse and internally persuasive discourse are described.
- **As reading**: Here we read the structure of relational composition in a site where different social languages (voices) coexist and negotiate. The level of similarity is structure, and we focus on the arrangement in which "dialogical relationships are woven in the midst of polyphony, and the order unique to the work arises."
- **As interpretation**: The space of heteroglossia in which socially stratified languages coexist without differentiation corresponds to Ba. The phase in which differences are made visible through opposition of voices and irony corresponds to Nami. The phase in which discourses intersect in dialogue situations and different "voices" are joined as relationships corresponds to En. The phase in which the polyphonic order unique to the work is formed corresponds to Uzu; and the phase in which it is incorporated into the literary system as genre conventions corresponds to Taba.
- The concept of dialogism describes En not merely as a "contact point" but as a more fundamental relationality — "that all utterances are already responses to others" — built into the very mode of being of language. In this respect, En is understood not simply as a stage but as a structure embedded in the existence of language itself.

Cross-Cutting Patterns

- The most striking pattern across literary studies is the diversity of implementations of En
- Second, the Taba→Ba cycle is explicitly described in multiple theories
- Third, literary studies naturally provides "separation of scales"

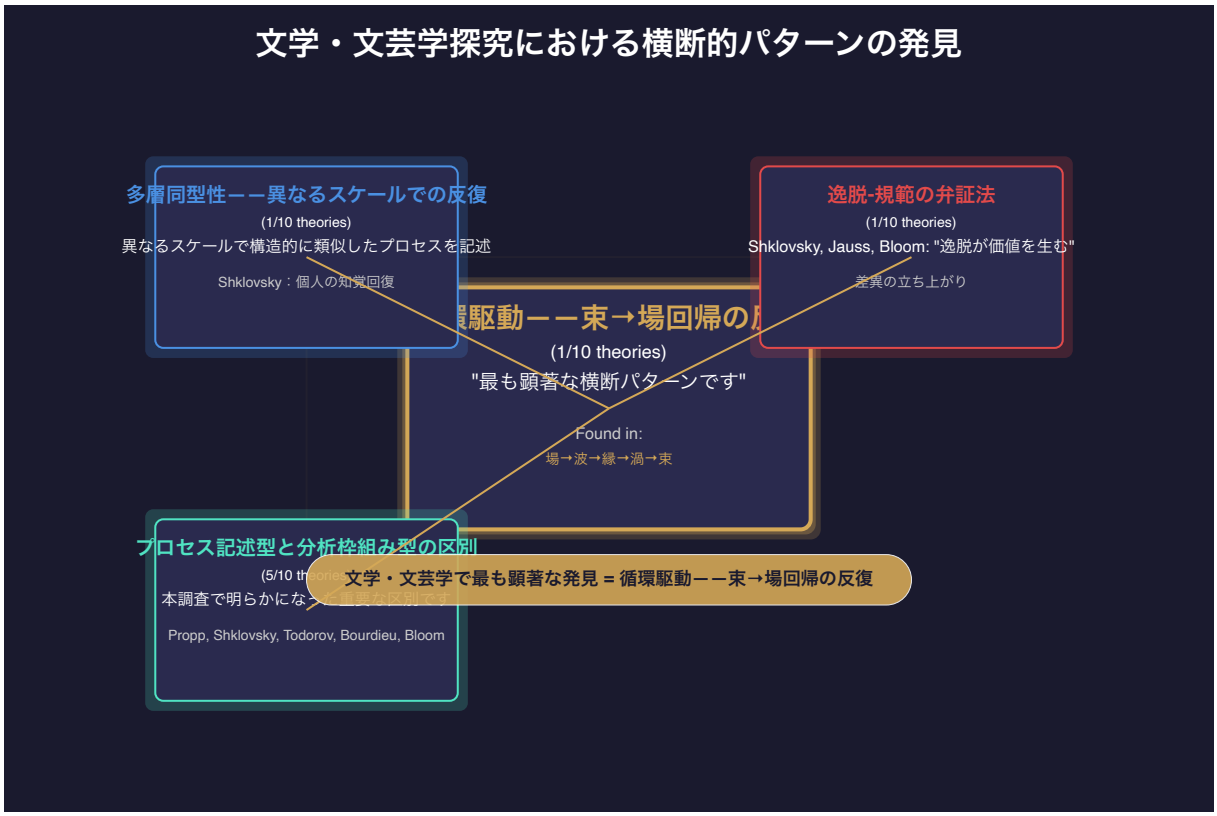

Figure 3: Domain — Cross-Cutting Patterns Diagram

Unresolved Questions

- Whether the five elements of Todorov's narrative structure — "equilibrium→disruption→recognition→response→new equilibrium" — correspond to the five-stage model by accidental numerical coincidence or structural necessity is held in suspension until verification with primary sources is complete. While widely circulated in secondary sources, the form of enumeration in the original text is unconfirmed.
- How to handle the numerical discrepancy between Bloom's six revisionary ratios and the five stages remains as a methodological problem. Whether the six revisionary ratios are a counterexample to the five stages, or can be organized as different phases within the five stages, requires further examination.
- Whether what literary theories describe is "analytic generation" (structure becoming visible through reading and understanding) or "existential generation" (the work itself coming into being) — the answer differs between theories that directly describe creative acts like Bloom and analytical frameworks like Genette. How this distinction limits the scope of the five-stage model is unresolved.
- The fact that there are ten types of En demonstrates diversity, but criteria for determining whether they are structurally the same thing or similar but different things have not yet been established.

Conclusion

- This survey confirmed that literary studies is a domain with overall probable structural similarity to the five-stage model
- Near-definitive are the lineages of Shklovsky, Jauss/Iser, and Bakhtin
- The greatest insight to be gained from literary studies is that the five-stage model shows structural correspondence not only in individual creative processes but also at multiple scales: the renewal of perception (Shklovsky), the interaction of text and reader (Jauss/Iser), and the autonomization of social institutions (Bourdieu)
- The findings of this survey are distributed from near-definitive findings to conditional hypotheses